Sanskrit Grammar

Classification of Nominal and Verbal Forms

సంస్కృత వ్యాకరణం

తిఙ్ సుబంతచయో వాక్యమ్ Tiṅ and Subanta are the two principal components in the formation and analysis of a sentence.

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1 Fundamental Classification

తిఙ్ సుబంతచయో వాక్యమ్

Dhātu (ధాతువు)

⇓

Branch 1	**Branch 2**
Prātipadika ⟶ Subanta	Tiṅ-pratyaya ⟶ Tiṅanta
Nominal forms	Verbal forms

The classification begins with the Dhātu and separates into two principal routes:

1. **Nominal route:** Dhātu, Prātipadika, and the processes involved in forming Subanta.
2. **Verbal route:** Dhātu, Tiṅ-pratyaya, and the formation of Tiṅanta.

Avyaya, Upasarga, Viśeṣaṇa, and Sandhi are treated separately from these two principal routes.

2 Dhātu and the Ten Gaṇas

A Dhātu (ధాతువు) is the starting point for the two branches. The ten traditional gaṇas are:

No.	**Gaṇa**	**Telugu**
1	Bhvādi	భ్వాదిగణం
2	Adādi	అదాదిగణం
3	Juhotyādi	జుహోత్యాదిగణం
4	Divādi	దివాదిగణం
5	Svādi	స్వాదిగణం
6	Tudādi	తుదాదిగణం
7	Rudhādi	రుధాదిగణం
8	Tanādi	తనాదిగణం
9	Kryādi	క్ర్యాదిగణం
10	Curādi	చురాదిగణం

3 Branch 1: From Dhātu to Subanta

3.1 The Nominal Route

Dhātu
⇓
Prātipadika (ప్రాతిపదిక)
⇓
Relevant nominal processes
⇓
Subanta (సుబంతం)

The nominal route concerns the formation of nominal bases and their use in nominal forms. The following topics are associated with this route:

1. Kāraka (కారకం)
2. Strī-pratyaya (స్త్రీప్రత్యయం)
3. Upasarga (ఉపసర్గ)
4. Samāsa (సమాసం)
5. Sandhi (సంధి)
6. Taddhita (తద్ధితం)
7. Avyaya (అవ్యయం) — indeclinable forms are considered separately because they do not undergo ordinary nominal declension in the same way as declinable nouns.

These topics do not all perform the same grammatical function. Kāraka and Vibhakti concern grammatical relations and nominal inflection; Strī-pratyaya concerns feminine formation; Samāsa and Taddhita form new expressions or derived words.

3.2 Kāraka (కారకం)

The seven traditional kāraka relations are:

Kāraka	Telugu	Basic relation
Kartṛ	కర్త	Agent or doer
Karman	కర్మ	Object or target
Karaṇa	కరణం	Instrument or means
Sampradāna	సంప్రదానం	Recipient or beneficiary
Apādāna	అపాదానం	Source or separation
Adhikaraṇa	అధికరణం	Location or locus

Kāraka	Telugu	Basic relation
Hetu / related cause	హేతువు	Cause, where relevant to the analysis

The standard Pāṇinian list of six kārakas is Kartṛ, Karman, Karaṇa, Sampradāna, Apādāna, and Adhikaraṇa. If a seven-item classification is intended in the course notes, the seventh category should be specified according to that classification. The seven Vibhaktis are a separate list.

3.3 Vibhakti (విభక్తి)

The seven principal vibhaktis are:

1. Prathamā — ప్రథమా
2. Dvitīyā — ద్వితీయా
3. Tṛtīyā — తృతీయా
4. Caturthī — చతుర్థీ
5. Pañcamī — పంచమీ
6. Ṣaṣṭhī — షష్ఠీ
7. Saptamī — సప్తమీ

3.4 Vacana (వచనం)

Nominal forms distinguish three numbers:

- Eka-vacana — ఏకవచనం — Singular
- Dvi-vacana — ద్వివచనం — Dual
- Bahu-vacana — బహువచనం — Plural

Thus, the nominal paradigm has seven principal vibhaktis and three numbers:

$$\boxed{7 \times 3 = 21 \text{ nominal positions}}$$

Vibhakti	Eka	Dvi	Bahu
Prathamā	1	1	1
Dvitīyā	2	2	2
Tṛtīyā	3	3	3
Caturthī	4	4	4
Pañcamī	5	5	5
Ṣaṣṭhī	6	6	6
Saptamī	7	7	7

4 Forming New Nouns

New nominal expressions can be formed from existing words by processes such as Samāsa and Taddhita.

4.1 Samāsa (సమాసం)

Samāsa combines words into a compound.

Rāma + Lakṣmaṇa

⇓

Rāmalakṣmaṇa

రామలక్ష్మణ

The example illustrates the combination of two nominal elements into a compound expression.

4.2 Taddhita (తద్ధితం)

Taddhita suffixes derive a new word from an existing nominal base.

Raghu + derivative suffix

⇓

Rāghava

రాఘవ

Rāghava is used in the sense of a descendant of Raghu, or a son of Raghu in the example.

4.3 Strī-pratyaya (స్త్రీప్రత్యయం)

Strī-pratyayas are suffixes associated with the formation of feminine nominal forms.

They are included among the processes relevant to nominal formation, alongside the other operations listed above.

5 Branch 2: From Dhātu to Tiṅanta

5.1 The Verbal Route

Dhātu
⇓
Tiṅ-pratyaya selection
⇓
Pada + Puruṣa + Vacana + Lakāra
⇓
Tiṅanta / finite verbal form

The verbal route determines the appropriate verbal endings and forms from the Dhātu.

5.2 The Three Pada Categories

1. Parasmaipada — పరస్మైపదం
2. Ātmanepada — ఆత్మనేపదం
3. Ubhayapada / Ubhaya — ఉభయపదం

Ubhaya refers to roots or usages that take both Parasmaipada and Ātmanepada endings, as applicable.

5.3 Puruṣa (పురుషం)

The three grammatical persons are:

Puruṣa	Telugu	English correspondence
Prathama	ప్రథమ పురుషం	Third person
Madhyama	మధ్యమ పురుషం	Second person
Uttama	ఉత్తమ పురుషం	First person

5.4 Verbal Vacana (వచనం)

- Eka-vacana — Singular
- Dvi-vacana — Dual
- Bahu-vacana — Plural

5.5 Lakāra: The Ten Time-Transform Categories

No.	Lakāra	Telugu	Introductory association
1	Laṭ	లట్	Present
2	Liṭ	లిట్	Perfect / completed past
3	Luṭ	లుట్	Periphrastic future
4	Lṛṭ	లృట్	Future
5	Leṭ	లేట్	Vedic usage
6	Loṭ	లోట్	Imperative / command
7	Laṅ	లఙ్	Imperfect / past
8	Liṅ	లిఙ్	Optative / injunction
9	Luṅ	లుఙ్	Aorist / past
10	Lṛṅ	లృఙ్	Conditional

5.6 Combined Verbal Classification

The verbal form is organised by combining:

- 10 Lakāras
- 3 Puruṣas
- 3 Vacanas

For each lakāra, the person-and-number grid contains nine positions:

$$3 \text{ Puruṣas} \times 3 \text{ Vacanas} = 9$$

Across ten lakāras:

$$\boxed{10 \times 3 \times 3 = 90 \text{ positions per pada}}$$

The combined grid below shows the nine person-number positions for each lakāra. Actual endings and forms depend on the Dhātu and the selected pada.

Lakāra	Prathama			Madhyama			Uttama		
	Eka	Dvi	Bahu	Eka	Dvi	Bahu	Eka	Dvi	Bahu
Laṭ	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Liṭ	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Luṭ	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Lṛṭ	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Leṭ	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Loṭ	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Laṅ	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9

Lakāra	Prathama			Madhyama			Uttama		
	Eka	Dvi	Bahu	Eka	Dvi	Bahu	Eka	Dvi	Bahu
Liṅ	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Luṅ	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Lṛṅ	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9

6 Topics Set Aside from the Two Main Routes

The following are treated as separate topics in the overall classification.

6.1 Avyaya (అవ్యయం)

Avyayas are indeclinable forms. They do not undergo the ordinary case-and-number declension characteristic of Subanta forms.

6.2 Upasarga (ఉపసర్గ)

Upasargas are prefixes associated with roots and derived forms.

6.3 Viśeṣaṇa (విశేషణం)

Viśeṣaṇa means an adjective or qualifier. It describes or qualifies a noun or another expression.

6.4 Sandhi (సంధి)

సంధి — Sandhi

Word Fusion

(Global / Universal)

Analytic to Synthetic

Sandhi concerns the joining and adjustment of sounds at relevant boundaries. It is treated as a general process, rather than being placed exclusively under the nominal or verbal route.